

CHENG LU



PERSONAL PROFILE

Marketing & PR | Content Creation | Travel service | AI Co-Creation

With over eight years of experience in content strategy, brand communications, and partnership management, I have recently focused on destination marketing, cultural experience curation, and integrated communications. My cross-cultural background, combined with a Master's degree in Entrepreneurship and Innovation from the UK, has shaped my expertise in online travel platforms and experiential travel product design. I excel at developing localised marketing strategies informed by market insights and user needs, and I thrive in multicultural, cross-functional environments to deliver impactful results through creativity and collaboration.

CORE COMPETENCIES

- **Integrated Destination Marketing & Content Strategy**
- **Travel Trade Partnership Development & Management**
- **Event Planning & Execution:** Roadshows, Industry Conferences, Offline Activations
- **Vendor Management & Budget Control**
- **Cross-Cultural Communication & Team Collaboration**
- **Market Insights & Consumer Behaviour Analysis**
- **AI Tool User:** ChatGPT, NotebookLM, Gemini, and Cursor.
- **Languages:** Chinese (Mandarin) & English

EDUCATION EXPERIENCE

Lancaster University | Master's Degree in Entrepreneurship & Innovation
Sep 2023 - Nov 2024

- During the "Design Thinking and Innovation" course, I conducted fieldwork and on-site research in Lancaster, **proposing a presentation to Lancaster City's business development department—an opportunity awarded to the top 30% of the cohort—receiving unanimous recognition**
- Conducted comparative analysis of online travel platforms (Tripadvisor, Airbnb, GetYourGuide) and proposed experiential travel product concepts targeting young travellers
- Developed a "Language Learning × Travel" cultural tourism business model, exploring inbound tourism opportunities through cultural experience design

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Tieci Travel | Marketing Manager | Remote | Jan 2026 - Aug 2026

- Focused on decision points faced by international visitors when understanding Shanghai, local life, and Chinese food culture. Refined local immersive experience routes such as market + food and ceramics + food. Used AI tools to build product detail pages, translating route highlights, suitable audiences, experience flow and trust cues into product expressions that users can understand, compare and book. Managed content communication across Xiaohongshu, Instagram and YouTube

Freelancer | Shanghai | August 2025 - Present

- Independently manage a travel-focused vlog (5,000 followers), creating cross-cultural content series with over 100,000 views, strengthening audience engagement through storytelling
- Developed content strategy for travel platform "Parallel Light" from scratch, establishing brand narrative and content production workflows; achieved 2,000+ followers across platforms in 1 month with 0 budget
- Participated in a Tibet intangible cultural heritage research project, conducting fieldwork on Bangdian weaving techniques and translating cultural assets into brand storytelling materials

Agriculture, Culture & Tourism Integration Project | May 2025

- Conceived and executed "Adopt a Fruit Tree" initiative, an agritourism model blending agriculture, community, and culture; attracted 200+ participants and generated 100,000+ media impressions
- Compiled local story archives through interviews with government and village representatives, laying the foundation for long-term rural tourism content

Rednote Influencer Campaign | KOL Strategy & Content Planning | April 2025

Planned social media campaigns for brands including Unilever and Walls' Ice Cream

Built a four-tier influencer strategy on Xiaohongshu

Managed 100+ KOL collaborations with planned posting frequency and campaign cycles

Generated 10M+ topic impressions for brand-related tags

SDG Changemaker | Assistant Researcher | Remote | Oct 2024 - Dec 2024

- Authored two research papers (10,000+ words each) on sustainable materials and community circular economy, providing literature reviews and case study support for a multinational sustainable development organisation

Mountains Consultancy | PR Director | Shanghai | Jan 2022 - Apr 2023

- Defined PR strategy for a newly established consulting firm; grew WeChat official account followers from 0 to 100,000+ within one year and built an industry media network covering 20+ key influencers and 10+ mainstream media outlets
- Elevated the founder's personal brand through in-depth content and community building, achieving 90%+ event participation rate and establishing the firm's thought leadership position

SGAD advertising | PR Director | Shanghai | Jan 2021 - Jan 2022

- Managed company retreat planning and execution, liaising with destination hotels and travel suppliers; delivered a 4-day, 3-night team trip at 50% of the original budget
- Expanded media partnerships in new consumer goods and technology sectors, enhancing cross-industry brand visibility and credibility

Soul | Brand Strategy Manager | Shanghai | Jul 2020 - Oct 2020

- Planned and executed the brand's first offline art exhibition, coordinating vendors and budget; attracted 10,000+ attendees, successfully establishing the brand's offline presence

Adquan | Senior Strategy Manager | Shanghai | Oct 2017 - Jul 2020

- Planned and managed five+ industry conferences, co-branded events, and workshops, negotiating with venues and suppliers; delivered a 1,000-attendee conference with triple the expected participation at one-third of the cost
- Maintained relationships with 100+ clients (4A agencies, local agencies, brands); grew a key account from 0 to 1 million CNY in two years
- Managed social media content: grew Zhihu followers from 1,000 to 30,000 and WeChat official account from 0 to 10,000+

Video++ | Business Manager (Live Streaming Division) | Shanghai | Feb 2015 - Sep 2017

Developed creative livestream content strategies and case studies for the company

Expanded partnerships with livestreaming and online video platforms

Supported the commercialisation of the company's AI SaaS products